

# Adam Pikielny

Research Scientist at Adobe. Computational photography, computer vision, deep learning.

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## Experience

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### Research Scientist, Adobe

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Member of Marc Levoy's computational photography team. I build models that advance the theoretical foundations of the field and are robust enough to ship on-device to millions of users.

## Education

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### Brown University, B.S. Computer Science

2022

Visual Computing and AI/ML pathways. Graduated with Honors and won the Senior Prize in Computer Science. Undergraduate research in James Tompkin's Visual Computing Lab on deep fake detection. Senior thesis, *Consistent Depth Estimation for Video*, won 1st Prize at the Brown CS Undergraduate Research Symposium.

## Publications

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### Hist2Style: Histogram-Guided Stylization with Bilateral Grids

CVPR 2026

Dekel Galor, Adam Pikielny, Zhoutong Zhang, Ke Wang, Laura Waller, Jiawen Chen, Ilya Chugunov.

### Removing Reflections from RAW Photos

CVPR 2025

Eric Kee, Adam Pikielny, Kevin Blackburn-Matzen, Marc Levoy. **Oral, top 0.7% of submissions.**

### Consistent Depth Estimation for Video

2022

Adam Pikielny, advised by James Tompkin, with help from Marc Mapeke. *Brown CS Senior Thesis. 1st Prize, Brown CS Undergraduate Research Symposium.*

## Shipped Products

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### Project Indigo, Adobe Nextcam

2025

iOS camera app with full manual controls, an SLR-like look, and the highest image quality on iPhone in both JPEG and RAW. Ranked #5 in top free video/photo apps in the US one week after launch and hit 1M downloads in four weeks with zero marketing.

### Reflection Removal, Adobe Camera Raw, Lightroom, Photoshop, Project Indigo

Dec 2024

One-click removal of window reflections from photographs. Productized from our CVPR 2025 research, with Eric Kee.

## Open Source Contributions

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## pconfigs, Adobe (Apache 2.0)

A dataclass-based Python config library. Configs are typed, inheritable Python classes that live next to the code they configure, instead of brittle text files that drift out of sync. We used it throughout the reflection removal project.

## Patents

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### Removing Image Overlays

filed Jan 2024

Eric R. Kee, **Adam A. Pikielny**, Marc S. Levoy. US Patent Application 18/426,758. Adobe Inc.

### Machine Learning-Based Chroma Keying Process

Oct 2024

Seoung Wug Oh, Joon-Young Lee, Brian Price, John G. Nelson, Wujun Wang, **Adam Pikielny**. US Patent 12,106,398. Adobe Inc.

## Awards & Honors

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- CVPR 2025 Oral, *Removing Reflections from RAW Photos* (top 0.7% of submissions)
- Senior Prize in Computer Science, Brown CS, 2022
- 1st Prize, Brown CS Undergraduate Research Symposium, senior thesis, 2022
- Adobe MAX Sneaks 2023, *Project See Through*

## Teaching & Mentoring

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Guest lecture, *Reflection Removal*, Brown University

Apr 2026

Guest lecture, *On-Device Computational Photography*, Brown University

Oct 2025

Mentored Adobe research interns Dekel Galor and Kevin Zhang

Teaching Assistant, CSCI 0220 Discrete Structures and Probability, Brown CS

Teaching Assistant, CSCI 1230 Introduction to Computer Graphics, Brown CS

## Press

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### Project Indigo

The Verge / PetaPixel / DPReview / DPReview Gear of the Year / AppleInsider / Tom's Guide / Popular Science / Six Colors / Fstoppers / BGR

### Reflection Removal

The Verge / Engadget / PetaPixel / DPReview / Digital Camera World / Creative Bloq / Fstoppers / TechRadar (MAX Sneaks 2023) / Brown CS

## Outside CS

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Videographer for action sports photographer Ming Poon. YouTube channel with over 320,000 views, featured by GoPro and Ski Utah. Brown Outing Club executive board; Utah Conservation Corps alum; AIARE Avalanche, Wilderness First

Aid, PADI, and chainsaw sawyer certifications.